Press Coverage Insights

What the coverage record shows works · Data as of Nov 5, 2026 · Ratings show how sure each finding is

Eight things to do

1. **Send a release at every bill introduction and every signing, small bills included.** Introductions with a release were covered 88% of the time, against 5% without one. Signings with a release were always covered (median 5 stories); without one, 58% were covered (median 1). MEDIUM-HIGH
2. **Stop sending releases that don't earn coverage.** Honors and awards: 1 of 7 got any story. "Passes the Assembly" outside food safety: median 1 story. Housing: 24 releases, median 1. District and community: 18 releases, 18 stories in total. Make floor votes a social post instead. MEDIUM
3. **Put the news in the title.** Releases with "first", "landmark" or "nation" in the title were picked up 97% of the time (median 13 related stories), against 72% (median 2) for the rest. Releases that name a bill: 81% against 59%. Part of this is the subject itself. MEDIUM
4. **Issue on Monday or Tuesday; avoid Wednesday and Thursday.** Monday releases were picked up 95% of the time, Wednesday 59% and Thursday 71% (ordinary releases, 2021 on, food safety left out). Friday releases get picked up but the stories land about 3 days later. Avoid the end-of-session crush in the second week of September. LOW-MEDIUM
5. **Give AP and CalMatters first looks on big news.** Their stories travel: each AP story ran in about 20 other outlets, and each CalMatters story in about 7. One placement there is worth many single-outlet stories. HIGH
6. **Make the Budget Chair role a story about him.** 358 budget stories since 2024, but only 12% feature him and 5% are positive; there were 17 budget releases against 393 budget stories in all. Offer background briefings before the January proposal, the May Revise and the June deal, and one budget op-ed per cycle. MEDIUM-HIGH
7. **Keep a 60–120-word Gabriel quote in every release.** Stories tied to a release quote him 69% of the time, against 35% for other stories. Quotes of that length get picked up most and are reused most. The 15 releases with no quote were picked up 47% of the time, but they were mostly weak kinds anyway. MEDIUM
8. **Give the district and in-language press something they can use.** District and Valley outlets carry 4% of his stories (157). Non-English outlets carry 11% (Spanish 179, Chinese 113, Korean 49), and 74% of those stories follow an English story rather than a release, because releases go out only in English. Add a translated quote on relevant bills for Sing Tao (rising: 10 stories in 2026), La Opinión, Telemundo 52, Univision 34 and Korea Daily, and a local angle for the LA Daily News and SFV Sun. MEDIUM

Key numbers

Measure	Value	Confidence
Releases with at least one story	75% (178 of 236); 40 got nothing	MEDIUM-HIGH
Stories per release	median 2; food safety median 20	MEDIUM
How fast coverage follows a release	78% by the next day; 91% within a week	MEDIUM
Share of all stories tied to a release (2021 on)	36%	MEDIUM
Food safety share of stories	23% (891); AB 418 alone 470 + 609 reprints	HIGH
Stories per year (2023 / 2024 / 2025 / 2026 so far)	764 / 714 / 642 / 607	MEDIUM
Share of stories that quote him (2023 → 2026)	52% → 41%	MEDIUM-HIGH
Tone (Neutral / Positive / Negative)	79% / 16% / 5%; 2026 the most positive year	MEDIUM
Negative coverage concentrates in	guns (17% negative); California Globe	MEDIUM
Top outlets, last 12 months	Politico 42 (incl. Pro), Bee 30, Sacramento TV 22, CalMatters 17, Jewish Journal 16	MEDIUM
September + October share of the year's stories	33%; November–February quiet	HIGH
Stories reprinted at least once	25%, 3.8 reprints each on average	MEDIUM-HIGH
Op-eds by Gabriel since 2018	4 (2026 CalMatters op-ed with Josh Hoover ran in 7 more outlets)	HIGH

Where the tracker undercounts

- **LA Times:** 28 → 17 → 2 stories (2024 → 2026). It blocks the web search, so this is mostly missed stories, not lost coverage. LOW
- **TV:** 84 → 36 stories a year (2023 → 2026). Partly real (LA stations: KTLA 1, ABC7 LA 0 in 2026), partly segments the search can't see. Check against the office's booking log before setting goals. LOW-MEDIUM
- **Spanish local press** (Adelante Valle, La Opinión) looks quieter, but it came mostly through NewsBank, which has thinned. Don't present it as a real decline.
- **The newest weeks** are about 80–85% complete until the monthly NewsBank download.

Track each quarter

- Bills with a release at introduction and at signing (goal: all of his bills).
- Releases picked up (now 75%; goal 80%+).
- Budget stories that feature him (now 12%; goal 20%+).
- District and Valley stories (now 4%; goal: a clear rise).
- Stories that quote him (now 41%; goal: back above 50%).
- LA TV and radio stories, compared with the office's own bookings.

How sure: HIGH the pattern is clear and would hold with complete data. MEDIUM the direction is right but the size may be off. LOW worth testing, not a rule. The figures show what goes together, not proof of cause: big bills get both more releases and more coverage.

Sources: Coverage, Press releases and Bills tabs of the office tracker (fingerprint 3a98feb1), Nov 5, 2026. "Stories" counts originals only, leaving out verbatim release copies; reprints are counted separately. Tone is rated by Claude (the AI the tracker uses) with a written rubric.